

Information Checklist – Court-issued Estate Documents

Goal: Flag and extract key textual elements in state-court issued letters that appoint a personal representative for the estate of a decedent.

Field	What to Extract / Identify	Keyword or Context Cues	Notes / Validation Target
1. Document Type	If it is a court-issued letter appointing an individual(s), as the administrator of an estate	“Executor” or “Letters of Administration,” “Letters Testamentary,” “Letters of Office,” “Certification of Qualification/Administration,” “Letters of Authority”	Flag misclassified docs. If the document is not a court decree / letters issued by a court concerning the estate of a decedent, but has to do with a decedent’s estate or property, then it may be a small estate affidavit.
2. Name of the Estate	Name of the deceased individual whose estate is the subject of the letter.	“Estate of [Name],” or the name of the “decedent”	Extract full legal name
3. Representative Name(s)	Name(s) of appointed representative(s). This is the individual appointed to administer the state in the letters	This individual is also called an “executor,” “representative,” “executrix,” “personal representative,” etc. Look for “appoints.”	Extract all listed representatives
5. Type of Administration	Identify if it is a supervised or unsupervised administration. Identify any limitations /	“Unsupervised,” “supervised,” “formal unsupervised,” “formal unsupervised,”	Extract type of administration if the letters include it (<i>sometimes they don’t</i>)

	restrictions, and if actions require court approval.	"limitations," "limited authority,"	
6. State and Court Reference	Identify the state and court	"State of [X]," and "Court" or "division"	Extract the State and Court
7. Signature and name of the Judge	Judge's information listed towards the bottom of the document	"Judge"	Flag presence
8. Effective Date	If there is an effective date listed and/or the date it is signed by the judge	If an explicit effective date, then it will say. If not, then the date of the Judge's signature	Extract exact date
9. Stamp or seal	Detect stamps or seals	Likely be a stamp with the judge or clerk's information	Flag presence
10. Expiration	Identify expiration date. Identify any termination clauses. (<i>These letters don't typically state termination</i>)	It might say that the appointment ends upon termination or court revocation	Capture date and trigger phrases (<i>if any</i>)
14. Completeness Check	Verify all pages present	"Page X of Y," header/footer patterns	Flag missing or out-of-order pages